

Open Your First Chart

Getting Started | beginner | 5 min to complete | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

By the end you will have a live price chart open, updating, and set to the timeframe you want. Opening a chart in DeepCharts takes two clicks, but the first time you do it there are a few things worth understanding: where the instrument list comes from, why the chart takes a few seconds to build, and what the three dropdowns in the chart's title bar control.

Before you start

- DeepCharts installed and activated — How to Install DeepCharts and Activate Your License
- A data feed connected — How to Connect a Data Feed (Feed Settings), or the free 15-minute delayed feed if you have no credentials yet. (Charts also work with recorded data via Replay Market Data.)
- The exchanges you trade mapped to your feed — the startup wizard normally does this for you; Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed covers it in detail

Steps

1. Check that your feed is connected: the feed selector at the top right of the main bar shows your connection name with a **green dot**. If it reads **Select a connection**, open the dropdown and click your saved connection.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The main bar feed selector at top right showing a connected feed name with a green status dot, with the dropdown open listing saved connections and the Feed Settings item dc-en-first-chart-01.png

2. Click **New** → **Price Chart** in the main bar.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The New menu open on the main bar with Price Chart highlighted (other items visible: Adv. Time And Sales, Book, Correlation Viewer, Profile Chart, Scanner) dc-en-first-chart-02.png

3. The **Select Instrument** dialog opens. Pick an exchange in the left sidebar (for example **CME**), or use the **Type to filter** box to search. Click your symbol — for example **NQ** (MINI NASDAQ) — then click **Select**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Select Instrument dialog with the CME exchange selected in the sidebar, the symbol list showing NQ MINI NASDAQ highlighted, and the Type to filter box and Select button visible dc-en-first-chart-03.png

Note: The dialog only lists exchanges that are subscribed in **Options** → **Symbol Manage**. If the list is empty or your exchange is missing, fix it there — see Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed.

4. Wait while the chart builds. A **Building chart** spinner shows for a few seconds, and a status badge appears in the main bar telling you where the data is coming from: **LDT** means it is loading from your disk, **DWT** means it is downloading from the feed server.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A new chart window showing the Building chart spinner, with the LDT/DWT status badge visible in the main bar dc-en-first-chart-04.png

5. The chart opens. The title bar has three dropdowns that control what you are looking at:

Control	Example	What it does
Symbol	NQ-202609	Opens Select Instrument to switch the chart to another contract
Data-load range	10D - BT	How much history is loaded — "10 Days, Based on Tick" (BM = Based on Minute)

Control	Example	What it does
Timeframe	5 Minute	The bar type and size the chart draws

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A finished price chart with the three title-bar dropdowns (symbol, 10D - BT range, 5 Minute timeframe) annotated `dc-en-first-chart-05.png`

If you want a different timeframe

Click the timeframe dropdown. Every bar type has its own row with quick presets: **Second**, **Minute**, **Time** (daily/weekly/monthly), **Vol Bars**, **Range**, **Volume**, **Trade**, **Renko**, **P/F** and **Delta**. Click a preset to rebuild the chart with it.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The timeframe dropdown open showing all bar-type rows (Second, Minute, Time, Vol Bars, Range, Volume, Trade, Renko, P/F, Delta) with their quick presets `dc-en-first-chart-06.png`

If you want more history on the chart

Click the data-load range dropdown. Short ranges load tick data (5/10/15/30/60 days); long ranges load minute data (3/6 months, 1/2/5/10 years); **Custom** opens a dialog where you set any day count plus a **Based on minute** checkbox. The default is 5 days.

Warning: Loading many more days makes the chart heavier — more RAM and CPU, slower loading. Increase gradually, and prefer minute-based data for multi-month ranges. Every indicator can only compute on the days the chart has loaded.

Verify it worked

Candles are drawn and the last price is moving. The readout in the top-left corner shows O/H/L/C values when you hover a bar. If you are on the free delayed feed, an orange banner notes the data is delayed — that is normal, prices update with a 15-minute lag (see Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed).

Not sure what those O/H/L/C values mean on a candle? Hover the anatomy below — each zone explains itself, and you can flip it between bull and bear.

[WIDGET: candle-anatomy]

If something went wrong

Symptom	What to do
Select Instrument dialog is empty	Nothing is subscribed in Symbol Manage — Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed
Chart opens but price does not move	Fix: Live Feed Connected but Chart Is Not Moving
"Connection lost" appears when opening the chart	Fix: Connection Lost When Opening a Chart
Chart stuck on Building chart / loads very slowly	Fix: Charts Lagging or Data Delayed (Checklist)

Related articles

- The Chart Window
- How to Connect a Data Feed (Feed Settings)
- Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed
- Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed
- Chart Display Options (Bar Styles, Sessions, Countdown)
- Quick Chart Templates (OF-VP, D-VP, W-VP...)